

SOLUTIONS · TEST 1

World religions - Part 1

Complete, self-contained answers and explanations

- Answer guide for the first test -

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For families and learning supporters

English · German exam terms retained

How to use this guide

Scope



This guide answers the class tasks that are relevant to Test 1 or to the shared overview. Every heading describes the task in words and all essential information appears in this document. No photographs or file names are required. Open personal questions do not have one single correct answer.

- Full sentences are best for explanation questions.
- Three points are clarified: Hira is near Mecca; symbol cards simplify; the hundred-square chart is an exercise, not a current world statistic.

1. Learning goals for Test 1

Test 1 content

- Shared overview: five world religions, broad distribution, Monotheismus/Polytheismus, questions and class content.
- Christianity: features, Jesus and a Catholic church.
- Islam: features, Mohammed and a mosque.
- Judaism: features, rules and customs.

Not studied in detail



The separate Buddhism and Hinduism blocks belong to Test 2. Their names, symbols and broad distribution may still appear in the shared overview.

Model answer: monotheism and polytheism

Monotheismus means belief in one God. Judaism, Christianity and Islam are monotheistic. Polytheismus means belief in several deities. Simple labels are only partly suitable for Hinduism and Buddhism.

2. Gap-fill text: basic knowledge

German answer words in gap order:

1-8	9-15	16-22
lateinischen höhere Macht wissenschaftlich Halt Weltreligionen besonders stark einen Polytheismus	Wertvorstellungen Charakter Verhalten Bauten Kirche Moschee Synagoge	Feiertagen Tod unterschiedliche frei wählen gar keine respektieren behandeln

Complete meaning without gaps

The word religion has a Latin origin. Many religions refer to a higher power or to the sacred; faith statements cannot be proved like scientific statements. Religion can give people support. The five world religions in this unit are Christianity, Islam, Judaism, Hinduism and Buddhism. Monotheistic religions believe in one God; polytheism means belief in several deities. Religions shape values, character and behaviour. They are also visible in buildings such as churches, mosques and synagogues, in festivals and in ideas about life and death. People may freely choose their faith or belong to no religion. Other convictions should be respected and people should be treated fairly.

3. Comprehension questions about the basic text

1. What are religions?

They are worldviews and lived traditions. They often include belief in a higher power or the sacred and shape values, rituals and community.

2. What are the five world religions in this unit?

Christianity, Islam, Judaism, Hinduism and Buddhism.

3. What can religious belief include?

Ideas about God or the sacred, values and behaviour, rules, customs, festivals, prayer, community, life and death.

4. Name one religious building.

For example, a church, mosque, synagogue or temple.

Clarification



The origin of the word 'religion' does not answer a question about the content of belief. The expected answer refers to ideas, values, behaviour and practice.

4. World map: colours, symbols and distribution

Religion	Map colour	Workbook symbol	Simplified main area
Judaism	blue	Star of David	Israel; worldwide
Buddhism	orange	Dharma wheel	East and Southeast Asia
Christianity	violet	cross	Europe, the Americas, parts of Africa, Australia
Hinduism	yellow	Om	India and South Asia
Islam	green	crescent	North Africa, West and South Asia

The map shows concentrations. Communities of all five religions live in many world regions today.

5. Hundred-square chart of religious affiliation

Group in the exercise	Squares	Chart percentage
Christians	31	31 %
Muslims	23	23 %
Hindus	15	15 %
Jews	1	1 %
Buddhists	7	7 %
other/no religion	23	23 %
Total	100	100 %

Important



This is the answer to the drawn hundred-square chart. It is not a reliable current world-population statistic.

6. Personal questions about meaning and faith

Personal answers differ. There is no single correct solution. Possible model responses:

Question	Possible personal response
How did the world begin?	Science explains processes; religions also pass on stories about meaning and origins.
What is the meaning of life?	For me: care for relationships, learn, help and take responsibility.
Does God exist?	People answer differently. I can respect convictions that I do not share.
How should people live together?	Fairly, peacefully, helpfully and respectfully.
What happens after death?	Religions give different answers; we cannot know with certainty.

7. Comparison of the five religions

Religion	Distribution	Age	God / people	Place	Text	Rules / customs
Christianity	worldwide	about 2,000 years	one God; Jesus	church	Bible	love of neighbour, festivals
Islam	worldwide	about 1,400 years	Allah; Mohammed	mosque	Quran	five pillars, Ramadan
Judaism	worldwide	over 3,000 years	one God; Abraham/Moses	synagogue	Torah/Tanakh	commandments, Shabbat
Buddhism	Asia; worldwide	about 2,500 years	Buddha; no central creator	temple	teachings	Eightfold Path
Hinduism	India; worldwide	over 3,000 years	diverse concepts	temple	e.g. Vedas	puja, festivals

Ages are rounded and are provided only as orientation.

8. Tasks about Jesus and Christianity

Task	Short answer
Who was Jesus?	A Jew from Nazareth and a preacher. In Christian belief, the Son of God/God as a human being.
Message	God's love and love of neighbour: 'Love your neighbour as yourself.'
Death	Crucified in Jerusalem under Roman rule.
Afterwards	Christian belief: resurrection on the third day, appearances and ascension.
Festivals	Christmas, Good Friday, Easter and Ascension.

Precise wording



Historically, Jesus came from Nazareth. According to the Gospels, he was born in Bethlehem. The class sheet simplifies; follow the wording used in class for the test.

9. Tasks about Allah, Mohammed and Islam

Allah

Allah is the Arabic word for God. Islam teaches belief in one God. The 99 names describe qualities of God, such as the Merciful or the All-Knowing.

Mohammed: gap-fill and crossword answers

No.	German answer	Connection
1	Gepriesene	meaning of the name in the exercise
2	Arabien	origin
3	Onkel	care after his grandfather's death
4	Predigten	Christian sermons
5	Höhle	Hira near Mecca
6	Medina	destination of the migration
7	Tod	after his wife's death
Final word	PROPHET	messenger who passes on God's message



Error in the question

The cave of Hira is near Mecca. If the task says 'near Medina', this is very likely a printing error.

Model answer: what is a prophet?

A prophet is a person who, according to religious tradition, receives and passes on God's message. In Islam, Mohammed is regarded as the final prophet.

10. Labels needed for Test 1

Catholic church

German term	Explanation
Altar	table used for the Eucharist
Ambo	lectern for readings
Tabernakel	place where consecrated hosts are kept
Taufbecken	baptismal font
Kruzifix	cross showing Jesus
Orgel	organ used in worship and singing
Weihwasser	holy water near the entrance; recalls baptism

Mosque

Term	Explanation
Mihrab	prayer niche showing the qibla
Qibla	direction of prayer towards Mecca
Minbar	pulpit
Gebetsraum	space for communal prayer
Gebetsteppiche	prayer places and rows
Waschung	ritual washing
Minarett	minaret; not every mosque has one

Synagogue - useful overview

Term	Explanation
Toraschrein	ark where Torah scrolls are kept
Bima	raised reading platform
Ewiges Licht	light near the Torah ark

11. New study card questions

Christianity K8 to K15

Question	Precise answer
Why is Sunday special?	It recalls Jesus' resurrection; Christians gather for worship.
Persons of the Trinity	Father, Son and Holy Spirit.
Main confessions	Three: Roman Catholic, Protestant/Reformed and Orthodox.
Head of the Catholic Church	The Pope.
Reformation	For the worksheet: Martin Luther. Historically, several reformers were involved.
Orthodox sacred images	Icons, Ikonen in German.
Example of a free church	For example Baptists, Methodists, Mennonites or Pentecostals.
Hope attached to pilgrimage	To deepen faith, pray, reflect on God and experience community.

Judaism K1 to K13

Question	Precise answer
Age and population	For the card: about 4,000 years and about 14 million. Current estimates are higher and depend on definition.
Country with most Jews	Israel, followed by the United States.
Covenant with Abraham	In Jewish tradition, God made a covenant with Abraham and promised him many descendants.
Expected deliverer	The Messiah.
Symbol	In this package: Star of David. The menorah is also an important Jewish symbol.
Sacred text	The Tanakh; its first central part is the Torah.
Place and day	Synagogue; Shabbat or Sabbath.
Kippah, tallit, tefillin	Head covering; prayer shawl; straps and boxes containing Torah passages.
Not eaten together	Meat and dairy products.
Doorpost case	Mezuzah; it contains a parchment with sacred text.
Sacred wall in Jerusalem	The Western Wall, also called the Wailing Wall.
Rabbis	Teachers and interpreters of Jewish tradition; they are not priests.

12. Accuracy check of David's answers

Worksheet	Assessment	Correction or clarification
Names of Allah	partly correct	Allah; der Wächter; der Liebende. 'Der Geliebte' has a different meaning.
Christian distribution	incorrect	Christianity is worldwide, not limited to western countries.
Quran delivery	partly correct	Chapters are Suren; the Quran is recited, not simply described as sung.
Five pillars	incomplete	Profession of faith, prayer, zakat, Ramadan fasting and pilgrimage; prayer was missing.
Content of faith	incorrect	Beliefs, values, behaviour, rules, customs, festivals, prayer and community.
Hundred-square chart	three figures incorrect	31 Christians, 23 Muslims, 15 Hindus, 1 Jew, 7 Buddhists and 23 other/none.
Jewish symbol	valid symbol, not the target answer	The menorah is Jewish; this package uses the Star of David for matching.
Shabbat	content correct	German spelling: Schabbat or Sabbat.

Blank lines were not assessed as answers by David.

13. Verified answers from the new worksheets

Bible and sacraments

Task	Checked answer
Bible sections	First/Old Testament and New Testament.
Number of books	66 in the Protestant canon; other Christian traditions count differently.
Gospels	Matthew, Mark, Luke and John; Evangelium means good news.
Catholic sacraments	Baptism, Confirmation, Eucharist, Penance/Reconciliation, Anointing, Holy Orders and Matrimony.
Protestant sacraments	Baptism and the Lord's Supper; confirmation and marriage are important services.

Quran and Judaism

Task	Checked answer
Quran	114 surahs; Arabic text; translations convey meanings.
Transmission	Preserved orally and in writing; collected and standardised after Mohammed's death.
Hebrew and Torah	Read right to left; a sofer writes a Torah scroll by hand on parchment.
Jewish festivals	Rosh Hashanah: New Year. Yom Kippur: repentance, forgiveness and reconciliation.
Synagogue	Torah ark, bimah, eternal light, mezuzah, siddur and cantor.
Hanukkah	Nine lights: eight festival lights plus the helper light, shamash.

The claims 'all prayers only in Arabic', 'an eight-branched Hanukkah lamp' and 'women always sit in a gallery' were not copied as universal facts.

14. Quick family check

1. Which five religions?

Christianity, Islam, Judaism, Hinduism and Buddhism.

2. Which three in detail?

Christianity, Islam and Judaism.

3. Which three are monotheistic?

Judaism, Christianity and Islam.

4. Christianity in three words

Kirche - Bibel - Jesus.

5. Islam in three words

Moschee - Koran - Mohammed.

6. Judaism in three words

Synagoge - Tora - Mose.

7. Hira?

A cave near Mecca.

8. Easter?

The resurrection of Jesus according to Christian belief.

Sources

Based on the supplied class materials. Curriculum cross-check: Lehrplan 21 for the Canton of Zug, NMG.12.1, NMG.12.2 and NMG.12.5 (zg.lehrplan.ch). The guide retains the German exam vocabulary and flags important simplifications.